SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #47 · MIRACLES & BLESSING

“If I give more, God must give me more.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Preaching that promises financial return for giving (“sow a seed to get a harvest”). Financial stress that makes a quick answer appealing. Giving with the hope of getting out of debt. Disappointment when giving did not lead to more money. Treating God like an investment that must pay off.

What Scripture teaches

God loves a cheerful giver, and generosity is a beautiful part of following Christ. But Scripture calls us to give freely, not as a way to obligate God. Jesus praised the widow who gave all she had, not because of what she would receive, but because of her heart. We are told to store up treasure in heaven and to be content with what we have. God does provide for His children, but He is not a vending machine.

> *“Each one should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver”* **(2 Corinthians 9:7)**.

Also see

> “Jesus called His disciples to Him and said, ‘Truly I tell you, this poor widow has put more than all the others into the treasury. For they all contributed out of their surplus, but she out of her poverty has put in all she had to live on.’” **(Mark 12:43–44)**.

> “Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” **(Matthew 6:19–21)**.

> “Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain. For we brought nothing into the world, so we cannot carry anything out of it. But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with these” **(1 Timothy 6:6–8)**.

> “But love your enemies, do good to them, and lend to them, expecting nothing in return. Then your reward will be great, and you will be sons of the Most High; for He is kind to the ungrateful and wicked” **(Luke 6:35)**.

Common self-statements

- If I give enough, God has to bless me financially.
- My giving is an investment with God.
- If I’m still struggling, I didn’t give enough.
- God owes me for what I’ve given.
- The more I give, the richer I should get.
- I give so that I’ll get.

Common logical errors

- **Transactional thinking:** Treating God like a business partner who owes a return.
- **Magical thinking:** Believing giving controls what God must do.
- **Personalization:** Blaming financial struggles on not giving enough.

- **Mixed motives:** Giving in order to get, rather than out of love.

Challenging questions

- Why does God love a cheerful giver?
- What did the widow receive in return for her gift?
- Am I giving to love God and others, or to get something?
- Can God be obligated by anything I do?
- Where does Jesus tell me to store up treasure?
- Have I made money the measure of God's blessing?
- What would giving look like if I expected nothing back?

Truth summary

> I do not give to make God give me more. I give because God has been generous to me, and because I love Him and others. God loves a cheerful giver, and He provides for my needs, but He is not obligated by my gifts. My treasure is in heaven, and I can learn to be content.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Giving
- Money
- Riches, True
- Riches, Beware of
- Thankful

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I give more, God must give me more"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I give more, God must give me more." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Why does God love a cheerful giver?
- ☐ What did the widow get in return?
- ☐ Am I giving to love or to get?
- ☐ Can my gifts obligate God?
- ☐ Where does Jesus tell me to store treasure?
- ☐ What if I gave expecting nothing back?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I give because God has been generous to me.
- ☐ God loves a cheerful giver.
- ☐ God is not obligated by my gifts.
- ☐ My true treasure is in heaven.
- ☐ Godliness with contentment is great gain.
- ☐ I can give freely and trust God to provide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **2 Corinthians 9:7**
  "Each one should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver."
- [ ] **Mark 12:43–44**
  "Jesus called His disciples to Him and said, 'Truly I tell you, this poor widow has put more than all the others into the treasury. For they all contributed out of their surplus, but she out of her poverty has put in all she had to live on.'"
- [ ] **Matthew 6:19–21**
  "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."
- [ ] **1 Timothy 6:6–8**
  "Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain. For we brought nothing into the world, so we cannot carry anything out of it. But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with these."
- [ ] **Luke 6:35**
  "But love your enemies, do good to them, and lend to them, expecting nothing in return. Then your reward will be great, and you will be sons of the Most High; for He is kind to the ungrateful and wicked."

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Generosity log:** Each day, write one way I was generous with time, money, or kindness, and what I received that wasn't money.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 2 Corinthians 9:7 becomes: "**Sarah** should give what **she** has decided in **her** heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Giving" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Give one small gift this week in secret,** expecting nothing in return, and notice how it feels.
- ☐ **Write down every way God has provided for you** in the past year that did not come as more money.
- ☐ **Read Mark 12:41–44 and Matthew 6:19–34,** and write what Jesus says about money and trust.
- ☐ **Talk with a wise Christian or financial counselor** about a healthy plan for giving and saving.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I give more, God must give me more": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One generous act expecting nothing
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I give more, God must give me more.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for Your generosity to me. Help me reject the lie that if I give more, You must give me more. Make me a cheerful giver who gives out of love, not to get. Teach me contentment, and help me store up treasure in heaven. In Jesus' name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.